

BEYOND THE KINGDOM — Character Bible

Document 02 · Locked Canon · Core Families & Principal Characters

All ages are exact as of Premiere Day: Monday, January 3, 2005

How to Read This Bible

- **Age (1/3/05)** is the exact age on premiere day. **Next birthday** shows the age they turn during 2005. Run ``python3 tools/ages.py YYYY-MM-DD`` for any date.
 - **"Black Don't Crack" rule:** Every character looks noticeably younger than their age. A **Looks** line gives the on-screen appearance age range for casting and description.
 - **SECRET** marks canon that is hidden from other characters, and sometimes from the audience. Nothing marked SECRET may be revealed on screen without a planned story arc.
 - All principal characters in this document are African American.
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Quick Age Reference — Premiere Day (Mon. Jan 3, 2005)

Character	Born	Age 1/3/05	2005 Birthday
Simone Donohue	Nov 2, 1910	94	Turns 95 — Wed Nov 2 (Nov sweeps)
Theodore Donohue	Jul 31, 1934	70	Turns 71 — Sun Jul 31
Victor Donohue	May 30, 1936	68	Turns 69 — Mon May 30 (Memorial Day)
Joan Donohue	Apr 17, 1938	66	Turns 67 — Sun Apr 17
Alvin Donohue	Oct 8, 1970	34	Turns 35 — Sat Oct 8
Peter Olson	Nov 13, 1959	45	Turns 46 — Sun Nov 13
Jasmine Olson	Mar 23, 1960	44	Turns 45 — Wed Mar 23
Martin Olson	May 15, 1981	23	Turns 24 — Sun May 15
Mallory Olson	Jun 5, 1985	19	Turns 20 — Sun Jun 5
Robert Bullock	Feb 10, 1959	45	Turns 46 — Thu Feb 10
Natasha Bullock	Jun 2, 1961	43	Turns 44 — Thu Jun 2
Elxa Jackson	Aug 29, 1980	24	Turns 25 — Mon Aug 29
Jeremy Jackson	Dec 2, 1980	24	Turns 25 — Fri Dec 2
Marc-Anthony Bullock	Jan 5, 1982	22	Turns 23 — Wed Jan 5 (Episode #0003)
Grace Bullock	Apr 12, 1984	20	Turns 21 — Tue Apr 12

Character	Born	Age 1/3/05	2005 Birthday
Amond Baker	Feb 10, 1982	22	Turns 23 — Thu Feb 10 (same birthday as Robert Bullock)
Esther Smilley	Sep 20, 1982	22	Turns 23 — Tue Sep 20
Arianna Cummings	Oct 25, 1982	22	Turns 23 — Tue Oct 25
Harmony Divine	Jun 19, 1982	22	Turns 23 — Sun Jun 19 (Juneteenth)
Emma Smilley	May 10, 2002	2	Turns 3 — Tue May 10 (May sweeps)
Victoria Smilley	May 10, 2002	2	Turns 3 — Tue May 10 (May sweeps)
Lyric Solace Baker	Apr 20, 2002	2	Turns 3 — Wed Apr 20

THE DONOHUE FAMILY

Alexander Josiah Donohue — The Founder (Deceased)

- **Born:** March 14, 1905, Americus, Georgia · **Died:** December 31, 1999, 11:58 PM, Donohue Manor, Belmont Crest (aged 94)
- Founder of Donohue Global Holdings and co-founder of Belmont Crest. He was born the son of sharecroppers and walked into Atlanta at 16 with three dollars sewn into his coat lining. He built the largest fortune in human history.
- He died two minutes before the year 2000. Family legend says he "refused to see a century he didn't build."
- His 1996 **Codicil to the Crown Trust** named his great-grandson Marc-Anthony the Heir Apparent. That decision still divides the family (see Document 03).
- **Quote carved over the Manor fireplace:** *"They closed every door, so I built the house."*

Simone Toussaint Donohue — The Queen Mother

- **Born:** November 2, 1910, New Orleans, Louisiana · **Age:** 94 · **Looks:** early 70s
- Creole of color and a licensed pharmacist (Xavier University of Louisiana, Class of 1931). Her apothecary formulas became the seed of Donohue Health & Beauty.
- Co-founder of Belmont Crest. In 1959 she stood on her porch with a shotgun while a cross burned at the front gate. The next morning she served the reporters coffee.
- She lives in the **Dowager House** at Belmont Crest. She still attends every Crown Council meeting and still has a vote. Everyone, including Victor, is afraid of her.
- **Holds:** "The Savannah Letter," the one document that proves what really happened between Alexander and Cornelius Smilley in 1952 (see Document 05).

- **Voice:** Soft Creole lilt, devastating one-liners, never raises her voice. *"Baby, I buried a husband, a century, and three governors. Don't try me before lunch."*
- **Relationship to Marc-Anthony:** He is her "Sunshine." He has Sunday dinner with her every week without fail.

Theodore Alexander Donohue — The Passed-Over Son

- **Born:** July 31, 1934 · **Age:** 70 · **Looks:** late 50s
- Eldest son of Alexander and Simone. Howard University School of Law. Fulton County District Attorney 1971–1987, then senior counsel to Donohue Global Holdings until he retired in 1999.
- **Respected, powerful, influential, corrupt, and ruthless.** As DA he buried cases for friends, built cases against enemies, and kept files on everyone in Georgia. Those files still exist, in a climate-controlled vault under his house.
- **The wound:** In 1966 Alexander gave Donohue Hospitality Group to Victor. In 1996 he gave the chairmanship of Donohue Global Holdings to Victor too. Theodore has smiled at every family dinner for 39 years and has forgotten nothing.
- **Married:** Three times. His current wife is **Constance "Connie" Donohue** (38; see Document 07). His son is **Reginald Donohue** (47; see Document 07).
- **SECRET:** Theodore is quietly advising Martin Olson on how to take the Heir Apparent designation away from Marc-Anthony. He plans to use Martin to put Theodore's branch of the family back on the throne.
- **Voice:** Courtroom baritone, Southern gentility, velvet threats. *"I don't hold grudges, nephew. I hold receipts."*

Victor Donohue — The King

- **Born:** May 30, 1936 · **Age:** 68 · **Looks:** mid-50s
- Youngest son of Alexander and Simone. Morehouse College '57, Harvard Business School '59.
- **Chairman & CEO, Donohue Hospitality Group (1966–1996).** He turned his father's Auburn Avenue hotel into the world's largest luxury hospitality empire.
- **Chairman & CEO, Donohue Global Holdings (1996–present).**
- **Respected, powerful, influential, ruthless, dangerous, and astronomically wealthy.** He negotiates by staying silent. Senators take his calls on the first ring, and his enemies sometimes hear from him only after their companies are gone.
- **Married:** Joan Mercer on **Saturday, June 20, 1959**, in the first wedding ever held at Belmont Crest Chapel.
- **Children:** Jasmine (1960), Natasha (1961), Alvin (1970).
- **With Marc-Anthony:** Victor sees himself in his grandson and worries about that. Victor privately suspects Marc is hiding something enormous. He hasn't asked, because he isn't sure he wants the answer.
- **Voice:** Measured, low, final. *"In this family we don't raise our voices. We raise our prices."*

The Honorable Joan Mercer Donohue — The Judge

- **Born:** April 17, 1938, Atlanta (Vine City) · **Age:** 66 · **Looks:** early 50s
- Spelman College '59. Married Victor two weeks after graduating. She was one of the few Black women in her Howard University School of Law class and graduated in 1964.
- Civil rights litigator from 1964 to 1979. She argued desegregation, voting rights, and fair-housing cases across the Deep South.
- **U.S. District Judge, Northern District of Georgia (1979–2003)**, appointed by President Carter. She took senior status and retired in 2003.
- **Respected, powerful, influential, astronomically wealthy philanthropist.** She chairs the **Donohue Foundation**.
- The moral center of the family, and the only person who can make Victor apologize. She believes in the law, which puts her in quiet, permanent conflict with her husband, her son-in-law Robert, and (without her knowing it) her favorite grandson.
- **Voice:** Precise, warm, withering. *"Objection, sustained, and sit down."*

Alvin Mercer Donohue — The Prince of Nightlife

- **Born:** October 8, 1970 · **Age:** 34 · **Looks:** late 20s
- Youngest son of Victor and Joan. He was a "surprise" baby born nine years after Natasha, and he has been spoiled rotten from the start.
- **A literal party boy.** He owns stakes in three Atlanta nightclubs (**Velvet**, **Sanctuary**, and **The Onyx Room**), a strip club he swears he doesn't own, and a Miami yacht nicknamed "The Alibi."
- **Deeply involved in politics:** He's a top Democratic fundraiser, bundles donations for city council, the state house, and Congress, and knows where every politician in Georgia drinks.
- **Deeply involved in the underworld:** He owes money and favors to **Silas Merriweather**, Atlanta's old-school kingpin (see Document 07). He launders club cash for people Victor has never heard of.
- **Sleeps around and never uses protection.** Nobody knows how many children he has, including Alvin.
 - **SECRET (seeded): Tremaine Banks** (12), son of **Rochelle Banks** of College Park, is Alvin's son. Rochelle has never asked for a dime. Tremaine has the Donohue eyes. More possible children are held in reserve for future stories.
- **With Marc-Anthony:** Alvin is Marc's favorite uncle and a terrible influence. Marc has quietly cleaned up three of Alvin's messes, and Alvin has no idea who did it.
- **Voice:** Loud, charming, a little too drunk. *"Mama says I'm the family's black sheep. I said, Mama, I'm the family's whole farm."*

THE OLSON FAMILY

Congresswoman Jasmine Donohue Olson — The Politician

- **Born:** March 23, 1960 · **Age:** 44 · **Looks:** mid-30s
- Eldest child of Victor and Joan. Spelman '81, Georgetown Law '84.
- **U.S. Representative from Georgia (1987–present).** She was sworn in January 1987 at age 26, among the youngest women ever elected to Congress. She represents the north-metro Atlanta district that includes Belmont Crest. (Following soap convention, the district is never given a real number on screen.)
- She sits on the House Ways and Means Committee and is openly mentioned as a future Senate candidate. Privately she has vice-presidential ambitions.
- **Married:** Dr. Peter Olson, Saturday, June 14, 1980. Their marriage is a genuine love match that is also a political partnership.
- **Children:** Martin (1981), and Mallory (1985), her "miracle child." Mallory came after a devastating 1983 miscarriage and doctors telling her she would never carry again.
- **Blind spot:** She sees Martin's hunger as ambition and cannot see that it's something darker.
- **Voice:** Poised, polling-tested, lethal off-mic. *"I have 700,000 constituents, Martin. Don't make me choose."*

Dr. Peter Olson — The Surgeon

- **Born:** November 13, 1959, Detroit, Michigan · **Age:** 45 · **Looks:** late 30s
- Son of an auto-plant foreman and a schoolteacher. He earned everything himself: University of Michigan '80, Johns Hopkins MD '84, residency and fellowship at Emory.
- **Chief of Plastic Surgery, Atlanta Presbyterian Medical Center.** Founder of **Olson Facial & Aesthetic Surgery** in Buckhead. He is dual board-certified in Plastic Surgery and Otolaryngology (ENT).
- **Respected, powerful, insanely wealthy.** Half the faces in Buckhead society are his work, and he keeps all of their secrets.
- Loves Jasmine deeply and worships Mallory. Where Martin is concerned he is quietly afraid, because he once saw what Martin did to a dog when Martin was nine.
- **Voice:** Gentle Midwestern calm. *"I can fix anything but a face that lies."*

Martin Donohue Olson — The Rival

- **Born:** May 15, 1981 · **Age:** 23 · **Looks:** early 20s
- Eldest child of Peter and Jasmine, and **the eldest grandchild of Victor Donohue.** He was born eight months before Marc-Anthony and believes that makes the throne his by right.
- Princeton '02 (economics, summa cum laude). **Senior Vice President of Strategic Development, Donohue Global Holdings.**

- **Marc-Anthony's fierce rival and sworn enemy.** Their rivalry started over toys, grew over grades, and became permanent on **Sunday, October 13, 1996**, when the Codicil was read aloud and Martin, then 15, heard his 14-year-old cousin named Heir Apparent.
- **He wants to be the Donohue Heir and take over the company.**
- **Astronomically deadly.** Martin is an expert marksman and a trained fighter who has studied poisons, and he has no conscience at all.
 - **SECRET:** Martin has killed three people as of 2005, each an "accident": a Princeton rival (1999), a blackmailing girlfriend (2002), and a DGH whistle-blower (2004). None of the deaths has been connected to him.
 - **SECRET:** He employs a private operator, **Cyrus Knox** (see Document 07), and has quietly started talks with **Desmond Smilley**, a Donohue enemy.
 - **SECRET:** Martin is hunting for the identity of "Sovereign," the boss of the Blackwater Syndicate, so he can destroy the organization and take credit for it. **He has no idea Sovereign is Marc-Anthony.** When he finds out, the war begins.
- **Voice:** Smooth, courteous, cold. *"Everyone loves Marc. That's what makes it so easy."*

Mallory Simone Olson — The Miracle Child

- **Born:** June 5, 1985 · **Age:** 19 · **Looks:** late teens
- Youngest child of Peter and Jasmine, and their "miracle."
- Very intelligent and business-savvy. Spelman College junior (economics), taking a lighter course load to run her father's practice as **Office Manager of Olson Facial & Aesthetic Surgery**. She has grown its revenue 40% in 18 months.
- **Spoiled and a daddy's girl.** She has a black AmEx, a white Range Rover, and she calls Peter "Daddy" in board meetings.
- **Planning to launch her own business with her cousin Grace: "GRACE & GLORY"**, a luxury beauty and lifestyle brand of skincare, fragrance, and cosmetics built on Great-Grandmother Simone's original 1930s apothecary formulas.
- **A virgin.** Her choice, her values, her business. It's never played as a joke.
- **Story seed:** She is falling, against every rule, for **Quentin Smilley** (see Document 05), a party boy from the enemy family.
- **Voice:** Bright, fast, a little bratty. *"Daddy, I didn't spend the money. I invested it in my happiness."*

THE BULLOCK FAMILY

Robert Lee Bullock, Esq. — The Fixer

- **Born:** February 10, 1959, Savannah, Georgia · **Age:** 45 · **Looks:** late 30s
- Son of a longshoreman. Morehouse '80, Yale Law '83.

- **Founder & Managing Partner, Bullock & Associates, LLP (1985–present).** It's the most feared criminal-defense firm in the South, with offices in Atlanta, Miami, New York, D.C., and Los Angeles.
- **Respected, powerful, influential, astronomically corrupt, astronomically ruthless, and insanely wealthy.** He has never lost a murder trial. Rumor says that's because some witnesses never make it to trial.
- **Married:** Natasha Donohue, Saturday, September 19, 1981. They're a power couple, and more partners in crime than a romance. They still genuinely want each other.
- **Children:** Elxa (1980, born before the wedding; a family "scandal" that's now a punchline), Marc-Anthony (1982), Grace (1984).
- **SECRET:** Robert has a long-running affair with his senior partner **Camille Rhodes** (see Document 07).
- **SECRET:** In late 2004, Robert and Victor privately leaned on the mayor to make Elxa Chief of Police. **Elxa doesn't know.**
- **Voice:** Silk and gravel. *"Innocent? Son, innocent is a price point."*

Natasha Donohue Bullock — The Queen of Hospitality

- **Born:** June 2, 1961 · **Age:** 43 · **Looks:** early 30s
- Middle child of Victor and Joan. Spelman '82, Wharton MBA '85.
- **CEO, Donohue Hospitality Group (1996–present).** She runs more than 3,100 hotels, resorts, casinos, cruise properties, and private clubs across 140 countries.
- **Respected, powerful, influential, ruthless, dangerous, insanely wealthy.**
- **She likes to bend the rules, and her son gets it from her.** She has bribed a Monaco zoning board, blackmailed a Las Vegas regulator, and once bought a Caribbean island to win an argument.
- **With Marc-Anthony:** He's her heart and her co-conspirator. She suspects he has secrets and has decided never to ask. "A mother knows when not to know."
- **Voice:** Glamorous, blunt, amused. *"Rules are for people without lawyers. I married a lawyer."*

Chief Elxa Bullock Jackson — The Law

- **Born:** August 29, 1980 · **Age:** 24 · **Looks:** early 20s
- Eldest child of Robert and Natasha. She was a gifted student who skipped two grades. Georgia State University B.S. in Criminal Justice (1999, age 18) and M.S. in Criminology (2001).
- Joined the **Atlanta Police Department** as soon as she met the minimum age. She rose through the ranks at a speed nobody in APD had ever seen:
 - Patrol officer (2001), then Detective in the Major Crimes/Homicide unit (2002).
 - Solved the **"Peachtree Strangler" murders** (2003) and made **Lieutenant, Homicide** (2004).
 - Her unit's clearance rate was the highest in APD history.

- **Chief of Police, Atlanta Police Department.** Appointed by Mayor Josephine Whitaker and sworn in **Monday, December 20, 2004**. She's the youngest big-city police chief in American history.
 - **Storyline:** Her appointment is a firestorm. Critics call her the "Nepotism Chief" (her father-in-law is the retiring chief and her family is the Donohues). Supporters point to her record, which is spotless.
 - **SECRET:** Her father and grandfather quietly pushed the mayor to appoint her. Elxa believes she earned it on merit alone, and her record says she did.
- **The complete opposite of her brother.** Elxa does everything **by the book**, and the book is her religion.
- **Married:** Detective Jeremy Jackson, **Saturday, October 16, 2004**, at Belmont Crest Chapel.
- **Her #1 case:** The **Blackwater Syndicate**. She has promised the city she will bring down "Sovereign." **She has no idea she's hunting her little brother.**
- **Voice:** Clipped, controlled, cop-flat. *"I don't do favors, Marc. I do warrants."*

Marc-Anthony Bullock — The Heir Apparent

- **Born:** Tuesday, January 5, 1982, Crawford Long Hospital, Atlanta · **Age:** 22 (turns **23** on Wednesday, January 5, 2005, in Episode #0003) · **Looks:** early 20s
- Second child and only son of Robert and Natasha. Grandson of Victor and Joan. Great-grandson of Alexander and Simone.
- **Billionaire Heir and Primary Heir Apparent of the Donohue family**, named by Alexander's 1996 Codicil. Under its terms he becomes eligible to take the **Vice Chairmanship of Donohue Global Holdings on his 25th birthday (January 5, 2007)** and the Chairmanship when Victor steps down. The clock is ticking, and Martin knows it.
- **The Golden Boy of the Donohue Family.**
- **Education:**
 - Graduated Belmont Crest Academy at 12 (1994).
 - **Morehouse College**, B.S. Mathematics and B.A. Economics, 1997 (age 15).
 - **Harvard**, joint **J.D./M.B.A.**, 2001 (age 19).
- **IQ:** A reported **250**, the highest ever recorded. He has a reputation for exceptional intelligence: he reads a 400-page contract in 20 minutes, speaks nine languages, and plays chess against three people at once while roasting all of them.
- **Founder, Chairman & CEO, Blackwater Security International (BSI), 2002–present** (see Document 06).
- **SECRET (maximum clearance): Founder & Boss of the Blackwater Syndicate (2000–present), known only as "SOVEREIGN."** Only the Syndicate's inner circle, "The Seven," know his face. Arianna Cummings knows but is not a member.
- **Net worth:** Forbes' publicly estimated figure is **\$38.6 billion (2005)**. The true figure, counting everything off the books, is much higher. His **future personal net worth will pass \$990 billion and keep rising every single day.**

- **Personality:**
 - **The sweetest, kindest, most loving, compassionate, innocent, and pure man in the world.** He tips waiters 100%, remembers every staff member's kids' birthdays, and cries at movies.
 - **But hurt someone he loves and he becomes a monster: a dangerous, unstoppable man.** There's no middle setting.
 - **A certified crash-out.** (Writers' shorthand only: Harry Potter and Percy Jackson times 2000. In-universe, Percy Jackson won't be published until June 2005.) When he snaps, cars flip, buildings burn, and companies vanish by morning.
 - **Bends the rules and takes creative liberties** whenever the rules or laws are unjust, unfair, or ridiculous. His motto: *"The law is a floor, not a ceiling."* He's the complete opposite of his older sister Elxa.
 - **Exceptionally outgoing and charismatic.** He's a natural in the spotlight and on camera, and the tabloids love him.
 - **Natural appearance, distinctive features, and effortless charisma.**
 - **Genuinely hilarious.** His comedy is unhinged, unfiltered, and offensive, and nobody is safe, including himself and his grandfather.
- **His #1 ultimate dream: A family, a big, gigantic family.** Kids are **non-negotiable**. He believes in **generational wealth**.
 - **Kids love him and he loves kids.** He mentors 40 boys through the Donohue Foundation, reads to the pediatric ward at Eggleston Children's Hospital every other Thursday, and is godfather to Lyric Solace Baker.
 - **SECRET (dramatic irony): He already has two daughters, twins Emma and Victoria Smilley, and has absolutely zero idea.**
- **Love interest / soulmate: Esther Smilley.** They have not met yet as themselves, and their story won't start right away.
 - **SECRET:** They met exactly once, masked, on the night of **Saturday, September 1, 2001**, at a Labor Day weekend masquerade (see Esther below). Marc remembers only a gold mask, a laugh, and the smell of jasmine. He has quietly looked for "the woman in the gold mask" ever since.
- **Relationships:** Ride-or-die with Grace. Brotherhood with Amond. Unbreakable friendship with Arianna. Loving, argumentative war with Elxa. Blood feud with Martin. Adores Simone, Joan, and Nana Ruby (the Bullock housekeeper). Currently on-and-off with news anchor **Celeste Vaughn** (see Document 07).
- **Residences:**
 - **The Bullock Pavilion**, 25 Sovereign Way, Belmont Crest.
 - The 58th-floor penthouse of BSI Tower in Midtown.
 - A villa in St. Barthélemy.

- **Voice:** Sweet, fast, filthy, brilliant. *"I'm the nicest man you'll ever meet. Now touch my sister again and meet the other guy."*

Grace Natasha Bullock — The Star

- **Born:** April 12, 1984 · **Age:** 20 · **Looks:** late teens
- Youngest child of Robert and Natasha.
- **Respected and powerful actress and singer.**
 - Starred as "Keisha" on the UPN sitcom **Sweet Tea** (2000–2004).
 - Her debut album **Amazing Grace** (Oct 2004) went platinum in six weeks. The lead single is "Crown Me."
 - She's now shooting her first major studio film.
- **Planning to launch her own business with her cousin Mallory: GRACE & GLORY** (see Mallory).
- **Ride-or-die with her brother.** She would literally hide a body for him.
 - **SECRET:** On the night of **Saturday, July 15, 2000**, when she was 16, Marc and Amond saved her from men who drugged her at a Buckhead party. She knows the men were never seen again. She has never asked what happened. That night is the reason the Blackwater Syndicate exists (see Document 06).
- **Voice:** Sunny, sassy, fierce. *"I love my brother. I own a shovel. Those facts are unrelated."*

Detective Jeremy Jackson — The Boy Scout

- **Born:** December 2, 1980 · **Age:** 24 · **Looks:** early 20s
- Son of **former APD Chief Harold Jackson** (see Document 07). Clark Atlanta University '02.
- **Senior Detective, APD Homicide.** He's the department's best interrogator.
- **A Boy Scout (literally an Eagle Scout) who does things 100% by the book.** He has never taken a free coffee.
- **Married:** Elxa, October 16, 2004. **Storyline:** His wife is now his boss's boss's boss. His marriage, his career, and his pride are on a collision course.
- Likes Marc personally but doesn't trust him. He is the first person to notice that the Blackwater case and the Bullock family keep crossing paths.
- **Voice:** Earnest and stubborn. *"Rules are what keep us from becoming them."*

THE INNER CIRCLE

Amond Baker — The Right Hand

- **Born:** February 10, 1982 · **Age:** 22 · **Looks:** early 20s
- Son of **Dr. Curtis Baker** (dentist) and **Gloria Baker** (high school principal). They're an **upper-middle-class** family in the Magnolia Terrace section of Belmont Crest (see Documents 04 and 07).
- **Marc-Anthony's best friend, brother, and right-hand man** since kindergarten at Belmont Crest Academy. Morehouse '04 (business).
- Publicly: **Senior Vice President of Strategic Operations, BSI.**
- **SECRET: Underboss of the Blackwater Syndicate**, "The Right Hand." He's second only to Sovereign.
- **He wants to become a respected, powerful, ruthless, dangerous, and corrupt businessman.** He grew up next to billionaires and is tired of being "the dentist's son."
- **Father of Lyric Solace Baker.**
 - Lyric was conceived in July 2001 after one night with **Harmony Divine** at a Midtown club.
 - Harmony tracked him down in February 2002, and a DNA test confirmed he's the father. Amond acknowledged Lyric immediately and pays generous support through attorneys.
 - Marc-Anthony is Lyric's godfather.
 - **But Amond and Harmony don't really know each other.** They co-parent through lawyers, nannies, and 10-minute handoffs in the Phipps Plaza parking deck.
- **Love interest:** Harmony Divine. Their story becomes an on-again, off-again, toxic, electric relationship once they finally have to talk to each other.
- **Voice:** Cool, calculating, hungry. *"Marc was born a king. I have to be made one."*

District Attorney Arianna Cummings — The Right Hand Woman

- **Born:** October 25, 1982 · **Age:** 22 · **Looks:** early 20s
- Daughter of media mogul **Franklin Cummings** and cardiologist **Dr. Yvette Cummings**. They're an **upper-class** family on Kingsridge Drive, Belmont Crest (see Document 07).
- **Marc-Anthony's female best friend, sister, and right-hand woman.**
- **A prodigy:**
 - Spelman College at 14, B.A. at 16 (1999).
 - **Emory University School of Law**, J.D. at 18 (2001).
 - Passed the Georgia Bar in July 2001 and was **admitted October 2, 2001**, three weeks before turning 19.
- **Fulton County District Attorney.**
 - Won the November 2, 2004 election over incumbent DA **Lawrence Tate**, who collapsed after a bribery scandal broke in September.
 - Georgia requires three years of active bar membership. She qualified by exactly **31 days**.
 - **Sworn in Saturday, January 1, 2005**, two days before the premiere.

- **She wants to become Attorney General of Georgia.**
 - **SECRET (maybe, maybe not):** She has skeletons in her closet that Marc helped bury.
 - **The truth:** On **New Year's Eve 2001 (early Tuesday, January 1, 2002, at about 2:40 AM)**, Arianna, 19 and drunk, hit and killed a man on a dark stretch of road off Northside Drive. She called Marc, not 911. By sunrise the car had been crushed and the body was gone. The victim was never reported found.
 - **SECRET within the secret:** The man was **Darnell "Dee" Divine**, the missing older brother of Harmony Divine. Harmony has been searching for him for three years.
 - **SECRET within the secret within the secret:** Marc also knows who tipped off the Tate scandal that got Arianna elected, because he did it.
 - Arianna knows Marc is Sovereign. She's **not** a member. She protects him with plausible deniability, and he protects her with silence.
 - **Voice:** Crisp, brilliant, guilty. *"Justice is blind, Marc. That's why I keep one eye open."*
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THE WOMAN IN THE GOLD MASK

Esther Odessa Smilley — The Heiress

- **Born:** September 20, 1982, Chicago, Illinois · **Age:** 22 · **Looks:** early 20s
- **Billionaire heiress of the Smilley family.** Youngest of three children of **Lucius and Vivienne Smilley**. Full family in Document 05.
- **Her parents' designated heir** to Smilley International, chosen over her older siblings **Luke** and **Delphine**. They have never forgiven her.
- Northwestern University, B.S. (2004), and the youngest person ever admitted to Kellogg's Executive MBA program. **President, Smilley International Atlanta**, the division leading the company's January 2005 headquarters move from Chicago to Atlanta, straight into Donohue territory.
- **1000% ruthless and corrupt.** She'll bribe, blackmail, seduce, sabotage, and smile the whole time.
- **The most beautiful and attractive woman in the world, all natural.** She's been on the cover of *Vogue*, *Essence*, *Ebony*, *Jet*, and *Forbes*.
- **Her best friend and sister:** Harmony Divine, her freshman roommate at Northwestern.
- **Love interest / soulmate: Marc-Anthony Bullock.** He doesn't know it yet, and their story won't start right away.
- **SECRET (the show's biggest secret):**
 - On **Saturday, September 1, 2001**, Labor Day weekend, Esther, just shy of 19, went to a private masquerade at a Sag Harbor Hills estate on Long Island. She wore a gold mask, drank too much, and spent the night with a funny, beautiful stranger in a black mask. He gave her a fake name ("Tony").

- She found out who he really was 11 weeks later, when she saw Marc-Anthony Bullock laughing on the cover of *Black Enterprise*. He's the heir of the family her family hates most.
- **She was pregnant with twins.** She decided alone to keep the secret and raise the girls as Smilleys.
- **Cover story:** She publicly chose IVF with an anonymous sperm donor. The tabloids called her "the youngest billionaire single mother by choice," and the world believed it.
- Only Esther knows the truth. Even Harmony believes the donor story.
- **Why it matters (see Document 03):** Under the Crown Trust Codicil, the Heir Apparent's line of succession runs through his children. **Emma and Victoria are Donohue heirs.** If the secret comes out, the two warring dynasties are joined forever.
- **Avoidance pattern:** Esther has skipped every event where Marc might appear, including Lyric's christening (where Marc became godfather). She always has a different excuse.
- **Voice:** Silk over steel. *"I don't need a man, a donor, or your permission. I need you out of my building."*

Harmony Divine — The Best Friend

- **Born:** June 19, 1982 (Juneteenth) · **Age:** 22 · **Looks:** early 20s
 - Daughter of **Calvin Divine** (MARTA bus operator) and **Loretta Divine** (Grady Memorial ER charge nurse). They're a **middle-class** family from the Cascade Heights neighborhood of southwest Atlanta (see Document 07).
 - Went to Northwestern on a full academic scholarship, where she roomed with Esther Smiley. They've been sisters ever since.
 - **Wants to become a respected and powerful real estate broker.** She got her Georgia real estate license in 2004 and is an agent at a small Buckhead brokerage, where she's hungry and underestimated.
 - **Mother of Lyric Solace Baker** with Amond Baker. See Amond for how that happened.
 - **Missing brother: Darnell "Dee" Divine** vanished on New Year's Eve 2001. Harmony has posted flyers, bothered APD, and run a LiveJournal called **"Find Dee"** every week for three years. **She has no idea the District Attorney killed him.**
 - **Love interest:** Amond Baker. It's on-again, off-again, toxic, and irresistible.
 - **Voice:** Warm, funny, relentless. *"I'm not pushy. I'm motivated. There's a difference and it's a commission."*
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THE CHILDREN

Emma Alexandra Smiley — The Elder Twin

- **Born:** Friday, May 10, 2002, 4:12 AM, Northwestern Memorial Hospital, Chicago · **Age:** 2 · **Looks:** 2
- Eldest daughter of Marc-Anthony Bullock and Esther Smilley. **Older twin by 6 minutes.**
- **Future canon:** 1000% a daddy's girl, spoiled by him endlessly, but she understands the true meaning of hard work. Respectful and responsible.
- **Nearly all of her talent and personality is inherited from Marc.**
 - At 2 she's already reading picture books aloud, doing 24-piece puzzles face-down, and correcting adults' grammar.
 - She has his dimples and his laugh. Esther hears it every day and it scares her every time.

Victoria Simone Smilley — The Younger Twin

- **Born:** Friday, May 10, 2002, 4:18 AM, Northwestern Memorial Hospital, Chicago · **Age:** 2 · **Looks:** 2
- Daughter of Marc-Anthony Bullock and Esther Smilley. **Younger twin.**
- **Future canon:** 1000% a daddy's girl, endlessly spoiled, but she knows the true meaning of hard work. Respectful and responsible, **and a literal wild child (contained).**
- **Nearly all of her talent and personality is inherited from Marc.**
 - She has already escaped two cribs, one nanny, and a Four Seasons presidential suite.
 - She's funny on purpose at age 2.
- **Name note:** Esther named her after "victory." She doesn't know that Victor Donohue is the girls' great-grandfather. The middle name "Simone" was Esther's grandmother Odessa's suggestion. Nobody at Ravenhurst knows it matches the Donohue matriarch's name. It's a coincidence nobody has noticed yet.

Lyric Solace Baker — The Angel

- **Born:** Saturday, April 20, 2002, Piedmont Hospital, Atlanta · **Age:** 2 · **Looks:** 2
- Daughter of Amond Baker and Harmony Divine. **Goddaughter of Marc-Anthony Bullock.**
- A literal sweetheart and an angel. She sings to strangers, shares every snack, and hugs dogs, security guards, and the occasional mall Santa.
- **Dramatic irony:** Lyric's best playmates are "Emmie and Tori," Aunt Esther's twins. The three little girls play together every week, and **Marc's goddaughter is best friends with Marc's secret daughters.**

Master Secrets Ledger (as of 1/3/2005)

#	Secret	Who Knows	Who Must Never Find Out (Yet)
1	Marc-Anthony is the father of Emma & Victoria	Esther only	Marc, Harmony, both families
2	Marc-Anthony is "Sovereign," boss of the Blackwater Syndicate	Marc, Amond, The Seven, Arianna	Elxa, Jeremy, Martin, the FBI
3	Arianna killed Darnell Divine (Jan 1, 2002)	Arianna, Marc	Harmony, Amond, the Divines
4	Marc leaked the Tate scandal to get Arianna elected	Marc	Arianna, Elxa
5	Victor & Robert pushed the mayor to appoint Elxa	Victor, Robert, Mayor Whitaker	Elxa, Jeremy
6	Martin has killed three people	Martin, Cyrus Knox	Everyone
7	Theodore is coaching Martin to take the Heir Apparent designation	Theodore, Martin	Victor, Simone
8	Martin is in talks with Desmond Smilley	Martin, Desmond	Both families
9	Tremaine Banks is Alvin's son	Rochelle Banks	Alvin, the Donohues
10	Robert's affair with Camille Rhodes	Robert, Camille	Natasha
11	What really happened in Savannah, 1952	Simone (the Savannah Letter)	Everyone
12	Marc & Esther's night in Sag Harbor	Esther knows it was Marc; Marc knows only "the gold mask"	Everyone

Continued in Document 03 (Donohue Global Holdings), Document 04 (Belmont Crest), Document 05 (The Smilleys), Document 06 (Blackwater), and Document 07 (Supporting Cast).